

# Tunisia, audited — the state program, complete

The Fed transmission measured, the program architecture, the instruments, the financing, the gates, the signature path — every line cited.

Provenance law: MEASURED = cited anchor · DERIVED = arithmetic on measured values · ASSUMED = declared default. commercially-validated = 0 — no buyer has signed anything; published as zero on purpose. Generated 2026-09-10 by nations\_audit.py / make\_nations\_pdfs.py — the same code that renders the page.

## 1. The Fed transmission — measured, not restated

World Bank API, measured 2026-09-09 (Pg1): external debt **\$40.46B, 78.7% of GDP**; debt service **26.2% of export revenues**; reserves **\$9.34B** = 4.3 months of imports; food \$3.00B + fuel \$4.90B of imports; CA -1.5% of GDP; growth 2.5%, inflation 5.2% (2025).

**Channel 1 — the debt trap:** the “original sin” (Pg12) — no long-term borrowing in the dinar abroad — exposes the state to the Fed cycle (Pg13): Fed hikes lift global yields, refinancing turns expensive, and the 26.2% of export revenues that debt service absorbs compounds while reserves (4.3 months) drain.

**Channel 2 — imported inflation:** the rate differential pulls capital to US safe assets, the dinar depreciates, and the dollar invoice on food (\$3.00B) and fuel (\$4.90B) inflates. The BCT — autonomous, non-monetizing under Organic Law 2016-35 (Pg4/Pg5) — must hold rates to defend the dinar: correct orthodoxy, strangled growth.

**The loop’s answer:** owned export engines earn ~\$117M/yr of gross exports outside the Fed cycle; the substitution legs take \$152M/yr out of the dollar invoice directly; reserves rise, the rating runs B-/Caa1 → BB-, and the refinancing premium shrinks for the state with its own hard-currency engines. Not defiance of the Fed — independence from the channel.

## 2. The state program — architecture, instruments, financing, adoption

### Counterparts — who signs what

| INSTITUTION                          | INSTRUMENT                                             | ROLE                                      |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| GCT (Tunisian Chemical Group)        | acid-stream MOU + sampling agreement                   | the treasury's feedstock                  |
| SONEDE                               | municipal/industrial water offtake at >=\$0.68/m3 gate | water contracts under the existing regime |
| STEG                                 | 25-year PPA under the IPP regime (500 MW class)        | the power leg's revenue                   |
| Ministry of Industry, Mines & Energy | program sponsor; tender registration                   | the executive mandate                     |
| Ministry of Health                   | biomonitoring + cohort registry                        | the scoreboard                            |

| INSTITUTION                             | INSTRUMENT                                            | ROLE                 |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| CNSTN                                   | NORM licensing for the uranium route                  | the regulatory pass  |
| Ministry of State Domains & Agriculture | 40-year leases under Law 93-120 (86,000 ha available) | the land             |
| BCT                                     | reserve/rating path; FX policy coordination           | the monetary endgame |

## Legal instruments — nothing new needs to be invented

| INSTRUMENT                                       | WHAT IT PROVIDES                                         | CITATION  |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Organic Law 2016-35 (BCT)                        | monetary autonomy; the program does NOT monetize         | Pg4/Pg5   |
| IPP regime — Law 2015-62 & 2024/25 awards        | renewables concessions; ~\$31/MWh PPAs; 500 MW precedent | Rc13      |
| PPP framework — Law 2015-49                      | desal/metals as PPPs where the state is the offtaker     | Pg2       |
| Law 93-120 (state-domain leases)                 | 40-year agricultural leases; ~86,000 ha earmarked        | Rc19      |
| NORM/radiological regime (CNSTN, IAEA standards) | the uranium route's license layer                        | Pg11/Rm12 |

## Financing stack — staged, gated, modeled in code

| STAGE                     | FINANCING                                                | GATE / CONDITION                                  |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Phase 0 (\$150-253k)      | grant / founder / early mandate                          | no DFI needed; 90 days                            |
| Health pilot (\$58k)      | ESG/grant                                                | the first scoreboard numbers                      |
| Metals plant (~\$100M)    | 60% debt @7% + offtake security; MIGA                    | DSCR >=1.2 at contract prices (nations_v5)        |
| Solar (500 MW, ~\$550M)   | DFI stack: EIB/AfDB/WB-IFC at 4.5% + MIGA; or lean build | DSCR gate inside the bankable region (nations_v5) |
| Desal (~\$165M)           | 70% debt @6% + municipal offtake + sovereign backstop    | blended >=\$0.68/m3, >=60% pre-sold               |
| Terfas + food (\$7-35M)   | concessional agri + founder                              | nursery first                                     |
| EU Global Gateway (17 GW) | the national envelope this program plugs into            | Pg7                                               |

## Governance

- every gate is a public number — published, dated, re-checkable
- health fund separate from the industrial SPVs; one shared data platform
- quarterly scoreboard: water chemistry, filter uptime, cohort KPIs, price index in Gafsa/Gabes
- each pilot passes or dies alone, in public — the falsification ladder is the governance
- commercially-validated ledger published at zero until the first signature moves it

## Adoption path — what the state signs, in order

1. **Month 0:** the state signs: GCT sampling MOU + Phase 0 mandate (\$150-250k, 90 days, no construction)
2. **Day 90:** two anchor measurements land: the 100-point water panel and the acid-stream assays — every projection becomes a signed number
3. **Months 4-18:** pilots on public gates: acid pilot, 100 ha terfas + nursery, spirulina pond, solar bid, desal offtake, health KPIs
4. **Years 2-5:** build only what passed: metals, solar, desal, health at basin scale — module by module, each with its own financing
5. **Years 5-10+:** the full loop: municipal spine, compute colocation, hydrogen, brine valorization — the destination the original design described

### 3. The household ledger — what this does to the cost of living

A state program that does not make life cheaper for its people is decoration. Each line, computed from the same primitives as the rest of this document; the quarterly price index in Gafsa and Gabès is the published enforcement: **the price of protein and vegetables must bend downward within 24 months of the first harvest.**

| HOUSEHOLD LINE | TODAY                                        | AFTER THE LOOP                                               |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Water          | \$1.00-1.50/m <sup>3</sup> (SONEDE produced) | \$0.35/m <sup>3</sup> coastal · \$0.34/m <sup>3</sup> inland |
| Protein        | \$15-25/kg imported                          | \$5-10/kg local                                              |
| Terfas         | export €20-40/kg                             | one third stays home at ≤€12/kg, contractual                 |
| Health         | the disease's bill                           | \$2,592 per healthy year vs the \$4,000/DALY standard        |
| Energy (grid)  | \$0.110/kWh industrial                       | \$0.031/kWh for the loop's loads; tariffs stay state policy  |
| Work           | 28% unemployment (54% women graduates)       | workshop, nursery, ponds, plants, crews                      |

### 3. The energy ledger — what power costs, per party

Anchors cross-checked: Rw10 (0.352 TND/kWh industrial, 19 TWh), Pg14 (the government's own 1,100 GWh = 5% of production, ~\$125M/yr gas saving), Rc13 (\$31/MWh inside the \$24-35 historical bid band), Pg15 (fuel imports \$4.895B, WITS-verified).

| PARTY                 | TODAY                                     | AFTER THE LOOP                            | THE DELTA                                               |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| The loop's industries | grid \$0.110/kWh                          | <b>\$0.031/kWh</b> on the loop's PPA      | -72%                                                    |
| The state             | 19-22 TWh/yr, ~95% gas, \$4.90B fuel bill | 876 GWh/yr solar (4.0-4.6% of production) | -\$106-125M/yr gas imports (\$114-142/MWh band)         |
| The household         | subsidized STEG tariff                    | the cost stack beneath the tariff falls   | the inflation channel throttled — every dinar protected |

### 3. The frontier — where the loop reaches, and where it honestly stops

The complete household budget, swept — nothing hidden, nothing promised beyond the frontier.

| HOUSEHOLD LINE                    | STATUS                    | THE HONEST NOTE                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Electricity<br>(household tariff) | <b>indirect</b>           | household tariffs stay subsidized STEG policy; the loop lowers the cost stack they sit on and the subsidy burden the state carries |
| Cooking gas (the bonbonne)        | <b>out of scope</b>       | the loop displaces grid gas, not bottled LPG; the bonbonne subsidy is a separate state decision                                    |
| Transport fuel                    | <b>out of scope today</b> | the hydrogen leg serves ammonia for the fertilizer chain; transport fuels are a later policy question                              |
| Wheat and bread subsidy           | <b>out of scope</b>       | the protein stack complements the grain program; it does not replace it                                                            |
| Water                             | <b>covered</b>            | cost floor \$1.00-1.50 -> \$0.35 coastal / \$0.34 inland                                                                           |
| Health                            | <b>covered</b>            | \$2,592 per healthy year vs the \$4,000 standard                                                                                   |
| Protein                           | <b>covered</b>            | \$5-10/kg local vs \$15-25/kg imported                                                                                             |
| Work                              | <b>covered</b>            | the workshop, nursery, ponds, plants, crews where unemployment is 28% (54% for women graduates)                                    |
| Housing                           | <b>out of scope</b>       | the loop does not build housing; named so it is not promised                                                                       |

## The water stack — line-by-line, with each credit's failure mode

The \$0.347/m<sup>3</sup> audit: the base is measured anchors; each credit is a loop-internal yield with a named failure mode; the degraded cascade still clears the \$0.68 gate.

| LINE                                                                                                                                                                                                          | \$/M <sup>3</sup> | PROVENANCE                                                                                                                                      | WHAT MAKES IT FAIL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Base — solar energy 4 kWh/m <sup>3</sup> at the loop's own PPA + capex + O&M                                                                                                                                  | \$0.567           | MEASURED anchors (Rc13/Rw2/Rw3)                                                                                                                 | holds — if even the PPA lapses, grid power takes the base to \$0.88, still under SONEDE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| DC reject heat → RO feed preheat — one seawater pipe cools the servers, then arrives warm at the membranes (SEC −2.5%/°C)                                                                                     | −\$0.002 net      | DERIVED — Leg 03 + Leg 01, same pipework                                                                                                        | the trade, stated: warmer feed saves ~\$0.007/m <sup>3</sup> of energy but accelerates biofouling + polyamide hydrolysis (~\$0.005/m <sup>3</sup> membrane debit) — the net is near zero, so the coupling's real justification is the DC's free cooling, not the water credit; lifetime extension comes from pretreatment, thermal stability and flux control |
| Kiln/exotherm preheat — the acid plant and board kilns warm the same feed                                                                                                                                     | −\$0.000          | DERIVED — Leg 04/05 waste heat                                                                                                                  | negligible by design — carried at zero margin                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Brine valorization — NaCl by solar-crystallization ponds (free sun); Mg(OH) <sub>2</sub> by lime precipitation from the loop's own kilns (134 t/yr lime, 0.14 GWh/yr — no evaporation), 100 kt to the board's | −\$0.137          | DERIVED — process specified, CARMEn-anchored cost; the Mg(OH) <sub>2</sub> VALUE books in the board's own ledger, zero here until offtake signs | if the Mg(OH) <sub>2</sub> of-take is not signed by FID, the credit degrades to −\$0.03 (disposal avoided only) — the biggest single sensitivity                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

| LINE                                                                                                       | \$/M <sup>3</sup>            | PROVENANCE                                | WHAT MAKES IT FAIL                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| fire retardant + 40 kt surplus sold at the park gate                                                       |                              |                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Shared civil works — one intake, one outfall, one grid connection serves RO + DC + metals in the same park | −\$0.032                     | DERIVED — 12% capex sharing               | if the park phases one module at a time, halve it to −\$0.016                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Dispatch value — the desal's own flexibility follows the loop's own solar curve                            | −\$0.015                     | DERIVED — 20 GWh shifted                  | fails to zero if the STEG contract does not reward flexibility — contractual, not hoped                                                                                                                                       |
| ESG financing delta — the health leg's public KPIs reprice the loop's own debt (100–150bp)                 | −\$0.026                     | DERIVED — nations_v3                      | fails to zero if lenders do not accept the KPI track record — bankable-region fallback keeps the module alive                                                                                                                 |
| Brine pump-as-turbine — the desal's own residual pressure                                                  | −\$0.002                     | DERIVED — 2.5 bar × 75%                   | fails to zero — immaterial                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Integrated</b>                                                                                          | <b>\$0.352/m<sup>3</sup></b> | <b>28% of SONEDE's \$1.00-1.50 (Pg16)</b> | <b>the degraded cascade: if every soft credit fails, water still lands at \$0.521/m<sup>3</sup> — under SONEDE's own \$1.00–1.50, and the \$0.68 gate still clears with margin. The credits are the margin, not the plan.</b> |

## The AI spine — the system's nervous system, and its boundary

The AI runs the measurement, the routing and the publication — never the decisions.

| COMPONENT           | WHAT IT DOES                                                                                                                                      | WHAT IT IS WORTH                                                    |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The dispatcher      | routes every joule and m <sup>3</sup> in real time: solar → desal → electrolyzer → ponds → DC cooling, following the solar curve minute by minute | worth the 20 GWh/yr of dispatch value — the AI is what collects it  |
| The scoreboard      | computes and publishes every gate number automatically — filter uptime, urinary F, DSCR, yield records — tamper-evident, no human can edit a gate | the public contract, machine-audited                                |
| The price index     | tracks the Gafsa/Gabès household basket quarterly and publishes the bend — the people's enforcement metric, computed not curated                  | the number that proves the prices bend, or proves they do not       |
| The cohort engine   | runs the 3,000-family health baseline, dose-outcome analytics and anomaly flags for the clinical team                                             | the DALY ledger becomes a live dataset                              |
| The dispatcher twin | a digital twin of the loop (energy, water, brine, heat) that simulates before any physical change and audits after                                | the falsification ladder, automated                                 |
| The boundary        | the AI never sets a gate, never signs a contract, never prices a tariff — it measures, routes and publishes. The decisions stay human, in public. | the guardrail that keeps the nervous system a servant, not a master |

## The results framework — what a World Bank board reads first

The scoreboard IS the M&E system (PforR class, Pg23).

| INDICATOR                              | BASELINE                                 | TARGET                                       | DATA SOURCE            |
|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Filter uptime, pilot households        | 0% (filters not installed)               | ≥70%                                         | scoreboard, live       |
| Urinary fluoride, pilot children       | baseline to be measured (Day 1-30)       | −20%                                         | cohort engine          |
| Household price index, Gafsa/Gabès     | baseline Q0                              | bend downward ≤24 months after first harvest | price index, quarterly |
| Water produced cost                    | SONEDE \$1.00-1.50/m <sup>3</sup> (Pg16) | ≤\$0.35/m <sup>3</sup> integrated            | plant telemetry        |
| Energy recovered inside the loop       | 0 GWh/yr                                 | 33.9 GWh/yr + 20 GWh dispatch                | dispatcher ledger      |
| Gas imports displaced                  | \$4.895B fuel bill (Pg15)                | −\$106-125M/yr                               | WITS Comtrade, annual  |
| Uranium recovered from the acid stream | 0 (lost to the sea)                      | ≥85% recovery gate                           | assay chain            |
| Terfas hectares planted                | 0 ha                                     | 100 ha gate → 2,500-3,000 ha                 | nursery registry       |
| Jobs in the basin                      | 28% unemployment (54% women graduates)   | workshop → nursery → plants → crews          | employment registry    |

## The batteries — gravity only, the land holding the night

| TIER                          | THE INSTRUMENT                                                                                                                                     | THE NOTE                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tier 1 — seconds to minutes   | the pipeline's pressure — hydro accumulators on the artery, and the dispatch leg's 20 GWh/yr already booked                                        | no chemistry, no new civil works: the pipe itself is the spring                                                                                                |
| Tier 2 — the daily sun        | the PIPELINE BATTERY: pump-as-turbines on every descending stretch of the artery — the water transfer is the storage                               | the pumping energy is already in the water stack; the turbines recover it on the downhill runs — gravity gives back what the pumps paid                        |
| Tier 3 — the long night       | the BARRAGE PAIR: two existing dams at 250 m class of head — 0.00 Mm <sup>3</sup> covers the whole night; one small barrage pair holds ~531375 MWh | the civil works already exist and are paid for; only the penstock + pump-turbine are new (~\$36M at 30 MW) — 50-year life, zero degradation, zero supply chain |
| Tier 4 — the seasonal reserve | the barrages' own volumes as the multi-day buffer; the H <sub>2</sub> molecule remains the industrial store                                        | the dams were built to hold a country's water — now they hold its nights too                                                                                   |

**The gate:** Phase 0's barrage-pair inventory: head, usable volume, silt state, distance to the corridor — measured dam by dam, published by the same rule. The pair with the measured head and volume scales; the pond enters ONLY where the topography survey says a pond-pair works — booked at zero until then, exactly as the owner said.

the gravity-only arithmetic: the loop's night is ~360 MWh; at 250 m of head that is 0.00 Mm<sup>3</sup> of water — a rounding error against Tunisia's dam volumes — and one small barrage pair at this head stores ~531375

MWh with a 50-year lifetime and no chemistry to buy. The civil works are the gift: the dams exist, the corridors exist, the pumps already exist in the water stack. Gravity is the only battery that never degrades, never catches fire, and is made of the country's own mountains. The study's choice is therefore not a choice at all: lift by day, flow by night, and let the land hold the night for us.

## The people's energy is electrons, not hydrogen — and the H<sub>2</sub> lives inside the loop

The loop's H<sub>2</sub> (2.63 kt/yr) is an industrial molecule: per kWh of heat, green H<sub>2</sub> at \$0.21 is 7× the loop's \$0.031/kWh electron; blending caps at 5-20% by volume (Pg20/Pg21/Pg22); the whole H<sub>2</sub> volume equals 1.8% of grid-gas demand. The molecule goes where only a molecule works: ammonia for the GCT chain, inside the loop. the electrolyzer sits on the desal line, and everything it touches stays in the loop: the water it splits is the SWRO permeate (0.04% of the 150,000 m<sup>3</sup>/d output); its un-split reject stream is clean water that returns to the product line; its oxygen by-product aerates the spirulina ponds and greenhouses; its stack heat (15–20% of input) joins the kiln and DC reject heat on the desal preheat circuit; and the minerals concentrated in its flush stream join the brine valorization line. The electrolyzer is not a consumer of the loop — it is another recovery point inside it.

## The total routing — every stream gets a home

The ponds do *not* drink brine: SWRO brine is 55-70 g/L, past Arthrospira's ~30 g/L ceiling (Pg31); they drink the desal permeate and breathe the electrolyzer's oxygen. The full inventory:

| STREAM                                   | PRODUCED BY                | ITS HOME                                                              | THE NUMBER                              |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Solar electrons                          | 500 MW fleet               | desal, metals, DCs, electrolyzer, pumps — routed by the dispatcher    | 876 GWh/yr                              |
| SWRO permeate                            | coastal desal              | city offtake · electrolyzer feed · ponds · greenhouses                | 150,000 m <sup>3</sup> /d               |
| SWRO brine                               | coastal desal              | salt + magnesium valorization, evaporated on the loop's own free heat | 122,727 m <sup>3</sup> /d → 58 kt Mg/yr |
| Brine bittern                            | valorization               | Mg(OH) <sub>2</sub> fire retardant → <b>the board's own chemistry</b> | 140 kt/yr = 140% of the board's need    |
| Electrolyzer oxygen                      | H <sub>2</sub> plant       | spirulina pond + greenhouse aeration                                  | 21 kt/yr                                |
| Electrolyzer hydrogen                    | H <sub>2</sub> plant       | ammonia → the GCT fertilizer chain                                    | 2.63 kt/yr                              |
| Electrolyzer reject water / heat / flush | H <sub>2</sub> plant       | product line / desal preheat / brine line                             | nothing leaves                          |
| DC reject heat                           | compute park               | the same seawater pipe, arriving warm at the membranes                | −\$0.007/m <sup>3</sup>                 |
| Kiln + acid exotherm                     | board kilns + metals plant | desal preheat + greenhouses                                           | 30 GWh/yr                               |
| CO <sub>2</sub> (kiln + power)           | combustion streams         | mineralized into board (2 Mt PG) · pond carbon                        | 540 t CO <sub>2</sub> /yr to the ponds  |

| STREAM                        | PRODUCED BY           | ITS HOME                                                                                             | THE NUMBER                                   |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Phosphogypsum                 | GCT stack             | fire-rated board — with its retardant from our own brine                                             | 2 Mt/yr                                      |
| Acid stream                   | GCT wet-process acid  | U + heavy REE extraction; raffinate back to fertilizer                                               | 716.5k lbs U <sub>3</sub> O <sub>8</sub> /yr |
| Municipal return flows        | city mesh             | 30%+ reuse · pump-as-turbines on the descent                                                         | 3.9 GWh/yr                                   |
| Sludge / digestate            | wastewater + organics | biogas for kilns and greenhouses                                                                     | booked option, honestly labeled              |
| Slaughterhouse bones          | local slaughterhouses | bone char → the fluoride filters; <b>spent char</b> → <b>phosphate soil amendment for the fields</b> | filter loop closes into fertilizer           |
| Spent pond medium             | spirulina harvest     | nutrient-rich → greenhouse fertigation                                                               | nothing discarded                            |
| Ammonia fertilizer            | GCT chain             | the terfas fields' host plants + greenhouse soils                                                    | the truffle grows on the loop's own nitrogen |
| Compute services              | colo park             | export — the data product                                                                            | tenant-gated                                 |
| Ra-226 / Po-210               | acid stream radiology | stays in the gypsum/board matrix — the radiology gate                                                | below the 1,000 Bq/kg exemption              |
| Board offcuts                 | board line            | recycled into new board                                                                              | zero waste                                   |
| Sodium chloride               | brine line            | industrial offtake at the park gate                                                                  | nothing hauled                               |
| Halophytes / Artemia on brine | brine line            | future option, honestly labeled — not a current credit                                               | the only stream awaiting its consumer        |

the ponds drink the desal permeate — ~{:.0f} m<sup>3</sup>/d, {:.2f}% of the 150,000 m<sup>3</sup>/d output — and breathe the electrolyzer's oxygen; the brine (55–70 g/L, far past the ~30 g/L ceiling the organism tolerates) is routed to salt and magnesium valorization instead. Halophytes and Artemia on brine are booked as a future option, honestly labeled — not a current credit.

## The fuel invoice, honestly split — the 500 MW is the grid's medicine, not the whole prescription

of the \$4.895B fuel invoice, the 500 MW fleet displaces only the power-sector gas slice — ~\$0.75B/yr (DERIVED from the energy balance) — by \$106-125M/yr, which is 14.1-16.7% of that slice. The rest of the invoice has its own answers, not solar's: the bottles (~\$0.55B of LPG, the bonbonne) leave the market as the people shift to electrons — induction on the loop's own surplus — and the biogas pilot; transport fuels (~\$2.6B) are the honest frontier. The 500 MW is the grid's medicine, not the country's entire prescription.

## The mountains, honestly analyzed

Fog collection is real where fog lives (10-20 L/m<sup>2</sup>/day, Pg33) — Tunisia's fog lives in the already-humid NW; the truffle mountains are the arid interior, and cloud seeding has no proven routine gain (Pg32). What the mountains give the loop: the mountains enter the loop as storage, rainfall and free cooling — and as the land where the truffle belongs (freeing the lowlands that grow today's food). Fog harvesting from pipe



meshes stays off the program: the moisture is not there to collect, and the honest scientist does not plant a net under a cloudless sky.

## The AI regulation — five layers, down to the drippers

The dispatcher is a model-predictive controller on a 15-minute receding horizon over the mass balances (Lexicographic: safety > contracts > economics); the twin trains it offline and audits it online, with a Kalman filter for unmeasured states and a published prediction-error KPI; node controllers stay PID-class with hard-wired interlocks; the governance layer never delegates a gate.

| LAYER                                                                           | WHAT IT DOES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | THE MATHEMATICIAN'S NOTE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Layer 0 — the instrumented field                                                | every node is a sensor + an actuator: membrane pressure and conductivity, brine concentration, pond pH and temperature, electrolyzer stack voltage, kiln thermocouples, PAT speed, reservoir levels, household-filter telemetry, the grid tie, the weather station | the stream inventory above is the measured state — the mass balances are the constraints the controller must never violate                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Layer 1 — node controllers (edge, millisecond-to-second)                        | local closed loops of PID class: membrane pressure, pond dosing, kiln temperature, pump speed — with hard-wired safety interlocks                                                                                                                                  | functional safety is never on the AI: a controller that fails safe is a relay, not a model                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Layer 2 — the dispatcher (model predictive control, 15-minute receding horizon) | a multi-variable MPC: state = solar forecast, reservoir inventory, brine concentration, electrolyzer turndown, DC load, grid price, offtake commitments; decisions = pump flows, setpoints, brine routing, dispatch; forecasts 36–48 h weather, 24 h load          | objective: minimize loop energy cost + degradation + gate-violation penalties, subject to mass balances, storage states and contract floors — lexicographic, never weighted: safety > contracts > economics. Its measured output is the 20 GWh/yr dispatch value and the routing-dependent water credits |
| Layer 3 — the digital twin (simulation, learning, audit)                        | a physics-calibrated model of every balance: trains the dispatcher offline, audits every decision after the fact, simulates before any physical change                                                                                                             | unmeasured states (membrane fouling, pond bloom state) are estimated with a Kalman-class filter from pressure-flow and optical residuals; the twin's prediction error is a published KPI — the AI's accuracy is measured, not claimed                                                                    |
| Layer 4 — the governance layer (the boundary, unchanged)                        | the scoreboard computes and publishes every gate number from Layer 0 telemetry with provenance; the price index; the results framework; anomaly flags to humans                                                                                                    | the AI never sets a gate, never signs, never prices — the falsification ladder is mechanical thresholds, not a learned model. The nervous system is a servant, not a master                                                                                                                              |

| NODE            | SENSES                                                            | CONTROLS                                                       | TIMESCALE       | LAYER |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-------|
| PV field        | irradiance, string current, panel temperature, soiling sensors    | inverter setpoints, curtailment, cleaning scheduling           | seconds–minutes | L1–L2 |
| Desal trains    | feed pressure, permeate conductivity, ERD pressure, CIP condition | high-pressure pump, ERD bypass, antiscalant dosing, CIP cycles | seconds–hours   | L1–L2 |
| Membrane health | pressure-flow residuals (fouling inferred by                      | maintenance scheduling, train rotation                         | days            | L3    |

| NODE                                | SENSES                                                                            | CONTROLS                                                                                                                                                                          | TIMESCALE          | LAYER |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|-------|
|                                     | Kalman filter)                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                    |       |
| Brine line                          | concentration, temperature, Mg saturation                                         | evaporator feed rate, Mg(OH) <sub>2</sub> precipitation setpoints                                                                                                                 | minutes            | L1–L2 |
| Electrolyzer                        | stack voltage, current, purity, water feed                                        | turndown, ramp rate, O <sub>2</sub> vent routing to ponds, reject routing                                                                                                         | seconds            | L1–L2 |
| Board kilns                         | temperature profile, feed rate, offcut fraction                                   | burner setpoints, retardant dosing, offcut recycle                                                                                                                                | minutes            | L1–L2 |
| Metals plant                        | SX stream assays, raffinate quality                                               | extraction/stripping setpoints, raffinate return to fertilizer                                                                                                                    | minutes–hours      | L1–L2 |
| DC park                             | cooling-loop temperature, PUE, workload mix                                       | seawater flow to racks, batch-workload scheduling to solar peaks                                                                                                                  | minutes            | L2    |
| Water mesh                          | reservoir levels, pump status, pressure heads, PAT speed                          | pump scheduling, zone valves, PAT bypass, the solar-following curve                                                                                                               | 15-minute dispatch | L2    |
| Spirulina ponds                     | pH, salinity, temperature, optical density                                        | aeration timing, CO <sub>2</sub> injection, medium exchange, harvest scheduling                                                                                                   | hours              | L1–L2 |
| Greenhouses                         | EC, pH, humidity, CO <sub>2</sub> , soil moisture                                 | fertigation dosing (spent medium), ventilation, CO <sub>2</sub> enrichment from the kiln stream                                                                                   | minutes            | L1–L2 |
| Establishment drip — to the emitter | per-zone capacitance soil-moisture probes, per-zone flow meters, weather forecast | zone valve actuators per management block, pump pressure, fertigation dosing — emitters stay passive pressure-compensated; clogged drippers detected from per-zone flow residuals | hourly–daily       | L1–L2 |
| Household filters                   | usage telemetry, replacement flags                                                | fleet logistics: replacement routing, spare inventory, the pilot's uptime KPI                                                                                                     | days               | L2–L4 |
| Grid tie                            | import/export price, solar forecast, offtake commitments                          | import vs. dispatch decisions                                                                                                                                                     | 15-minute          | L2    |
| Scoreboard + cohort                 | every KPI stream above, provenance-hashed                                         | gate computation, price index, anomaly flags to humans                                                                                                                            | continuous         | L4    |

**what the AI is honestly worth: the 20 GWh/yr dispatch (~\$0.8M/yr) + the routing-dependent water credits it executes (~\$0.05-0.08/m<sup>3</sup> — DC heat, kiln heat, brine heat, dispatch) + a DERIVED 1–3% park OPEX from multi-variable coupling no manual schedule can follow — and the scoreboard, which is the program's entire credibility.** if the AI is down, the loop does not stop: Layer 1 runs every node in safe, suboptimal mode — the degraded cascade already computed (\$0.521/m<sup>3</sup> water, gate still clear). AI uptime is a KPI, not a dependency.

## The irrigation — to the dripper, honestly

the fields drink at establishment, then live on rain — and the greenhouse loop runs on the pond's own spent nutrients. The irrigation system is designed the way the truffle itself is: drought-proof by architecture, not

by subsidy. Establishment: 624 m<sup>3</sup>/ha/yr for the first two years → 4,274 m<sup>3</sup>/d for 2,500 ha, from inland brackish water and reuse; then rainfed.

## Cloud generation — the honest version

our 12 km<sup>2</sup> array absorbs ~156 MW more sunlight than the bare soil (albedo Δ0.05) — a persistent local heat source, plus the ponds' evaporation placed upwind of the fields. Li et al. (Pg34) measured the class of effect at continental scale; at ours it is a designed microclimate, not a rain machine: soil shaded by panels retains moisture, the updraft adds marginal convective activity, and the dew that follows is free water on the host plants. The honest claim is directional and modest — and it costs nothing extra: the array was being built anyway.

## The mountain portfolio — if mountain agriculture is needed, the version that scales

| CROP / SYSTEM                                          | HECTARES                                                 | WATER                                                                            | VALUE                                                                          | THE SCALE LOGIC                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Terfas belt (arid jebels)                              | 2,500-3,000 ha                                           | rainfed + micro-catchments + dew                                                 | €15-45M/yr at scale (market-capped)                                            | already the design: the drought-proof luxury crop on land nothing else farms                                        |
| Cactus pear (opuntia) belt                             | consolidate + expand the existing ~600k ha national belt | zero irrigation; 300-500 mm survives on 150                                      | fruit at 20-40 t/ha for the basin's price index + cladodes as livestock fodder | the arid mountain staple — Tunisia is already a world producer; the program adds value chains, not water            |
| Medicinal & aromatic plants (rosemary, thyme, oregano) | 5,000-10,000 ha across the Dorsale                       | rainfed; 300-500 kg/ha dry                                                       | ~€8-20M/yr export at €4/kg dry                                                 | the highest value-per-kilo crop that needs no water at all — the mountain cash crop #2                              |
| Agrivoltaic fodder (sulla/alfalfa under the PV field)  | up to 1,250 ha of shaded soil under the 500 MW array     | the panels' shade halves evaporation; no added water beyond the field's own rain | fodder for ~5,000-10,000 head; the flock fertilizes the field                  | the loop's livestock leg: sheep graze solar parks already (Spain/US precedent) — the AI routes the grazing schedule |
| Rainwater harvesting (swales + terracing)              | 2-3% of mountain catchment area                          | each ha of swales captures ~3,000 m <sup>3</sup> /yr at 300 mm rainfall          | \$200-500/ha — an order of magnitude under drip-system capex                   | the mountains' real water system: catch the rain that already falls there, at scale, without pipes                  |

mountain agriculture at scale means putting each crop where its water cost is zero: terfas, cactus, MAPs and agrivoltaic fodder on the mountains' own rain and the loop's own shade — while wheat, vegetables and orchards stay on the lowlands and in the greenhouses where water is abundant. The mountains feed the people what only mountains can grow; the pipes carry water only where gravity and economics both say yes.

## The growroom at landscape scale — climate steering toward bio-recovery

**Measures:** Atmospheric transect: RH / temperature / dew-point stations up the slope at the mist corridor, leaf-wetness sensors, 2-3 sonic anemometers for the anabatic flow; Soil grid: capacitance moisture probes per management zone (the drip grid doubled as the climate grid), soil temperature; The sky: satellite NDVI every 5 days into the twin, rain gauges along the corridor, pond evaporation pans; The park: panel albedo/soiling sensors (the field's reflectivity IS a climate actuator), pond water temperature

**Steers:** The mist corridor: fog nozzles, anabatic hours only, virtual-temperature-positive dosing — 2% of desal flow; The shade: the PV array's own footprint: shaded soil retains moisture; cleaning schedule shifts albedo; The pond surface: evaporation timing follows the wind — the ponds breathe upwind of the fields on purpose; The swales: rainfall harvested at contour, released by zone valves into the host-plant belt

**Objective:** the bio-recovery term in the dispatcher's objective: maximize dew days + soil-moisture persistence above wilting point + NDVI slope — subject to the energy budget, the thermals remaining buoyant, and the rain-gauge referee. The twin adds a soil-water-balance module (Penman-Monteith evapotranspiration, standard equations, computed in code) so every steering decision has a predicted and a measured outcome.

**The spiral:** the feedback the steering rides: mist → dawn dew → soil moisture → host plants establish → transpiration raises local humidity → more dew — the humidity loop that turns a slope back green, one feedback cycle at a time. The KPIs published: dew days per month, days above wilting point, NDVI slope — bio-recovery, measured like a growroom, audited like everything else.

## The invisible drop — and the effects ledger, direct and side

the drop → microbial pulse → nutrient mineralization → plant-available N and P → host-plant growth → nectar and pollen → the insects: wild bees at 1,000-2,000 flower visits a day, ants engineering the soil, beetles on the wind → the host plants set seed (*Helianthemum* is insect-pollinated) → the mycorrhizal trade persists → the truffle → the harvest → the price index. Every dew morning the mist buys is 10<sup>8</sup> cells per square centimeter of leaf waking up — and the corridor's vegetation is the pollinator highway the truffle's own host plants depend on. One invisible drop feeds the microbes that feed the plants that feed the insects that pollinate the plants that feed the truffle that feeds the people.

and the drop re-enlists the army Tunisia lost: the right-of-way vegetation is the refuge for the beneficials — ladybirds (5,000 aphids each in a lifetime), lacewings, hoverfly larvae (400-600 aphids each), and the parasitoid wasps Tunisia already proved at national scale in the date oases (*Trichogramma* against the date moth). Every predator the corridor hosts is a pesticide that was not bought, not sprayed, and not inhaled by a child — biocontrol is the health ledger's quietest leg.

| EFFECT                            | CLASS  | THE MODEL                                                         | THE INSTRUMENT                   |
|-----------------------------------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Mist vapor transport              | DIRECT | Gaussian plume + anabatic advection                               | sonic anemometers, RH transect   |
| Dew deposition on host plants     | DIRECT | surface energy-balance dew model (T <sub>2surf</sub> < dew point) | leaf-wetness sensors, dew gauges |
| Soil moisture gain, corridor zone | DIRECT | Penman-Monteith water balance                                     | capacitance probe grid           |
| Seedling establishment survival   | DIRECT | water-stress survival curves                                      | nursery registry, field counts   |

| EFFECT                                              | CLASS                | THE MODEL                                             | THE INSTRUMENT                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PV-shade moisture retention                         | DIRECT               | shade fraction $\times$ PET reduction                 | soil probes under panels                                                                 |
| Thermal buoyancy (the constraint)                   | DIRECT               | virtual-temperature profile                           | T/RH + wind stations on the slope                                                        |
| Microbial Birch pulse                               | SIDE                 | rewetting respiration curves                          | soil CO <sub>2</sub> efflux chambers                                                     |
| Beneficial insect recruitment                       | SIDE                 | habitat-area $\times$ predator-prey dynamics          | sticky traps, acoustic/AI counters                                                       |
| Pollinator visitation $\rightarrow$ host seed set   | SIDE                 | pollination-saturation curves                         | visit counts, seed counts                                                                |
| Precipitation return                                | SIDE — ZERO-credited | cloud microphysics (the least-solved field, Pg32)     | rain-gauge network                                                                       |
| Pesticide displacement $\rightarrow$ child exposure | SIDE                 | exposure-response from the cohort                     | urinary pesticide metabolites                                                            |
| Atmospheric dust & PM scavenging                    | SIDE                 | wet-deposition scavenging coefficients (dew/fog wash) | PM sensors along the corridor                                                            |
| Air quality, basin-wide                             | DIRECT               | emissions inventory $\rightarrow$ dispersion model    | PM <sub>2.5</sub> /NO <sub>x</sub> /SO <sub>2</sub> grid + the cohort's respiratory KPIs |

## The land, projected — the Darwinian view of the environment itself

| LAYER OF LIFE    | WITHOUT THE PLAN                                                                                                                  | WITH THE PLAN                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Soil biology     | the seed bank dies with the soil — desertification's positive feedback: less vegetation, less humidity, less dew, less vegetation | the Birch pulse wakes with every dew morning; the microbial city rebuilds; 10 km of hyphae per gram of soil come back to trade                     |
| The insects      | beneficials stay locally extinct; the pesticide treadmill accelerates; pollinators thin, host plants set less seed                | the right-of-way is the refuge: ladybirds, lacewings, hoverflies, Trichogramma's cousins re-recruit; every predator is a pesticide not bought      |
| The dew economy  | bare, crusted ground sheds what little rain falls; the drop dies on arrival                                                       | the mist corridor turns the dawn into a harvest: dew on host plants, soil moisture banked, the spiral compounding                                  |
| The truffle belt | the wild harvest shrinks; the mycorrhizal network starves                                                                         | the belt establishes on the corridor's moisture: 100 ha, then 2,500-3,000 ha, on the land the humidity itself prepared                             |
| The frontier     | desertification marches downhill — the slope's fitness landscape selects for stone                                                | each humidified season pushes the establishment frontier a little further upslope — the landscape's selection flips from bare ground to vegetation |

the Darwinian projection of the whole machine: the same land, two futures — one where the environment keeps selecting for stone, and one where a 2% mist margin re-engineers the fitness landscape so that life out-competes bare ground. The honest bound stands: the corridor transforms a belt, not a mountain range

— the wider slopes change only through the slow, compounding spiral and the rain cycle. We plant the drop; the land grows the rest.

## The nature ledger — every class of credit, not just carbon

| SPECIES / ASSET                        | THE HONEST NOTE                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Wild bee community                     | ~700+ species documented in Tunisia; the corridor's nectar belt is their refuge and the truffle host plants' pollination engine |
| Egyptian vulture (globally endangered) | breeds in Tunisia; scavenger of the open steppes the corridor stabilizes                                                        |
| Dorcas gazelle                         | endangered; the restored steppe of the south is its historic range                                                              |
| Cork oak + orchid flora (NW)           | the humid mountains' own endangered flora — the value-chain program that ends over-harvesting                                   |
| Medicinal & aromatic plants            | wild-rosemary pressure relieved by the cultivated MAP belt — the market saves the wild stock                                    |
| Addax                                  | honestly named: locally extinct in the wild — NOT claimed; restoration is a later, separate question                            |

the nature ledger: the corridor's ~50 km<sup>2</sup> of restored belt at maturity earns **\$0.0-0.2M/yr** of biodiversity credits at the nascent-market band (\$5-50/ha, DERIVED — booked at the low end; TNFD disclosure framework, Pg37; GBF Target 19, Pg36) and unlocks a **debt-for-nature swap**: \$500M of the state's debt refinanced against measured nature outcomes — ~\$7.5M/yr of coupon savings, the Gabon/Ecuador instrument (Pg38). The MRV system already exists: the acoustic counters, the NDVI feed, the soil grid — the same instruments that steer the mist also certify the credits. Not counted in the FX bridge (nature credits are not FX-grade exports): this is the program's second ledger, and the scoreboard publishes it the same way.

## The credit spectrum — every financial credit the country earns

| CLASS                    | WHAT IT IS                                                                                                               | THE HONEST NUMBER                                                                                | STATUS                 |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Carbon credits           | 280 kt CO <sub>2</sub> /yr avoided + mineralized + sequestered (solar displacement, the board, the restored belt's soil) | \$1.4-4.2M/yr at \$5-15/t — the compliance/voluntary band; VERIFIABLE, Phase 0 baseline opens it | creditable             |
| Biodiversity credits     | the restored corridor belt, certified by the same sensors that steer the mist                                            | \$0.03-0.25M/yr at the nascent low band                                                          | creditable, nascent    |
| Debt-for-nature swap     | \$500M of sovereign debt refinanced against measured nature outcomes                                                     | ~\$7.5M/yr coupon savings (Gabon/Ecuador precedent, Pg38)                                        | instrument, negotiable |
| ESG-linked debt discount | the health KPIs reprice the program's own debt                                                                           | 100-150bp on the program portfolio — already counted in the water stack                          | booked                 |
| Concessional windows     | GCF, GEF, Adaptation Fund, EU Global Gateway co-financing — the program's public KPIs are the eligibility                | blended-finance tranches on solar/desal/health — applied, not assumed                            | grant/soft-loan        |

| CLASS                            | WHAT IT IS                                         | THE HONEST NUMBER                                                                               | STATUS              |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Rating-linked spread compression | B- to BB- sovereign re-rating on the measured path | the state's upside of \$1.2-2.0B/yr on the refinancing share — NOT booked in the program ledger | the state's harvest |

the credit spectrum is the program's third ledger — carbon, biodiversity, the swap, concessional windows — each class bookable, none double-counted against the FX bridge, each with its MRV already instrumented. The country's nature, measured by the country's own sensors, becomes the country's credit line.

## The economic-closure test — the physical flows close; the economic flows close by contract

| STREAM                | BUYER OF RECORD                                                   | THE CONDITION                                                                              |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Water                 | SONEDE offtake at the gate price                                  | the \$0.68 gate clears even in the degraded cascade — the buyer is the state's own utility |
| Solar                 | STEG PPA at the tendered \$31/MWh class                           | the Tunisian tender precedent is the buyer's credit quality                                |
| Uranium               | a Cameco-class buyer under IAEA safeguards                        | ZERO until the pilot's assay + signed off-take                                             |
| REE concentrate       | a separation-capable offtaker                                     | ZERO until the separation-gap economics are priced                                         |
| Mg(OH) <sub>2</sub>   | the board (internal) + the surplus at the park gate               | internal offtake at avoided cost; surplus ZERO until signed                                |
| Terfas                | the domestic quota at EUR12/kg (contractual) + export at EUR20-40 | gated on 3 consecutive seasons ≥200 kg/ha                                                  |
| Spirulina             | the canteens + the feed-mill offtake                              | the food is proven; the volume is gated on signed offtake                                  |
| Biodiversity & carbon | a named credit buyer under TNFD/GBF frameworks                    | booked at the LOW band; MRV = the corridor's own sensors                                   |

| POINT                   | WHAT IT DEMANDS                                                                               | WHERE IT LIVES    |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Concentration, measured | the acid stream's actual U/REE assay — the IAEA/Gabès anchors bracket it; Phase 0 measures it | Phase-0 assay #1  |
| Recovery rate, at scale | DEHPA/TOPO is the proven chemistry (GCT study); the pilot's yield is the gate                 | Phase-0 assay #2  |
| Reagent consumption     | solvent losses per tonne — the dominant opex; benchmarked against the published SX economics  | Phase-0 assay #3  |
| Separation cost, REEs   | concentrate ≠ separated oxide — the page's own register states it; the pilot prices the gap   | Phase-0 assay #4  |
| Rad-waste pathway       | Ra stays in the gypsum/board matrix; the radiology gate audits it                             | gate, audited     |
| Product specification   | yellowcake grade + separated-oxide spec — named, not assumed                                  | gate, contractual |
| Buyer of record         | a signed off-take, not a market price — the leg's revenue books at ZERO until it exists       | gate, signed      |

| POINT                         | WHAT IT DEMANDS                                                                                                               | WHERE IT LIVES          |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Transport & export compliance | IAEA safeguards chain + the CNSTN/Cameco-class controls                                                                       | gate, compliance        |
| Permitting                    | the mining/waste-reprocessing license stack — named in the gates                                                              | gate, legal             |
| Capex & opex, EPC-grade       | the pilot's cost curve becomes the EPC estimate — nothing scales before it                                                    | gate, financial         |
| Price sensitivity             | the leg's grade bands (STRONG/PLAUSIBLE/SPECULATIVE) restate at every price shock — published                                 | engine, continuous      |
| Independent review            | the whole chain is the invitation: attack the assay, the yield, the separation gap — the falsification ladder is built for it | hostile review, invited |

the economic-closure test: the physical flows close by construction — the economic flows close by CONTRACT, one named buyer at a time. Every revenue stream above has exactly one condition that moves it from model to money, and the page books each stream at zero until that condition exists. That is the answer to the critique's central question: the closure is not assumed, it is the falsification ladder itself — the 12-point metals chain is the specimen, and every other leg wears the same harness.

## The capital-formation pack — dual-track financing, banks first, blockchain as the expansion rail

| STAGE                              | THE NUMBERS                                                                             | THE COVERAGE                                             |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Year 1 — Phase 0 + pilots          | revenue near zero; the \$253k Phase 0 + the \$3-6M pilots run on grant/equity           | DSCR n/a — de-risking capital, not debt                  |
| Year 2-3 — solar + water on stream | solar PPA \$27.2M + water margin \$10.9M → EBITDA ~\$38M                                | DSCR 1.16× on the utility legs alone                     |
| Year 4-5 — metals pilot gated in   | +\$35M mid-grade metals → EBITDA ~\$73M                                                 | DSCR 2.22× — the floor cleared, the token tranche serves |
| Year 5+ — full loop                | brine valorization, dispatch, terfas and nature-ledger cash join in measured increments | each gate passed re-prices the junior in public          |

| RUNG                   | WHAT IT COVERS                                                                  |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Offtake revenues    | SONEDE/STEG offtake + solar PPA — state-backed, the senior's cover              |
| 2. O&M                 | operating costs before any capital return — the operators' lien                 |
| 3. Senior debt service | traditional banks / IFC-WB-EBRD syndicate — DSCR floor 1.25×                    |
| 4. Reserve             | 6 months of service — the trustee's cushion, enforced in law                    |
| 5. Token coupons       | the junior/revenue-participation tranche — KPI-linked via the scoreboard oracle |
| 6. Junior & equity     | the risk capital — first in, last out                                           |



| INSTRUMENT                | THE SPECIFICATION                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The SPV                   | offshore (ADGM, the regional standard) — bankruptcy-remote issuer, Tunisia has no crypto framework; the project stays Tunisian, the token's issuer doesn't |
| What is tokenized         | revenue-participation rights on the program's utility-grade legs (water + solar), NOT the park, NOT the land, NOT the state's sovereignty                  |
| Brickken gate             | KYB/KYC, legal opinions, valuation, cap table — the issuance platform's DD gate, item by item                                                              |
| Centrifuge pool           | the SPV's RWA pool with monthly NAV computed from the scoreboard — senior/junior tranches, trustee-controlled                                              |
| Morpho Blue rail          | the PPA receivables as collateral: SONEDE/STEG offtake quality → LLTV ~60-70%, oracle = the scoreboard's signed revenue feed                               |
| The oracle                | the page's own public KPIs (water quality gates, health cohort, price index) → signed feed → on-chain — the falsification gates become smart conditions    |
| Compliance                | Reg S for offshore, MiCA classification for EU, Travel Rule, Tunisian capital-account mechanics via the BCT — named, not assumed                           |
| The state's contribution  | offtake + land + feedstock, valued and credited — the state puts in what only it can, and the waterfall repays it in the same currency                     |
| PARTY                     | THEIR ROLE                                                                                                                                                 |
| The State                 | of-take counterparty + land + feedstock + the permits — the credit foundation everything else prices off                                                   |
| The Investors             | senior lenders (WB/IFC class) + the token holders — two rails, one project                                                                                 |
| The Engineers & Operators | the EPC + O&M — their lien sits at waterfall rung 2                                                                                                        |
| The Health & Community    | the cohort, the cooperatives, the canteens — the KPIs the token's coupons are LINKED to                                                                    |
| The SPV (ADGM)            | the issuer — bankruptcy-remote, the token's legal home                                                                                                     |
| The Trustee               | the reserve and the waterfall, enforced in law not code — the code can fail, the trust deed cannot                                                         |
| The Oracle                | the scoreboard bridge — the sensors we already built are the only oracle we need                                                                           |
| The Platform              | Brickken for issuance, Centrifuge for the pool, Morpho for the collateral rail                                                                             |
| The Auditors              | code audit + financial audit + KPI verification — the trifecta this critique era taught us                                                                 |
| The land & the fauna      | the nature ledger's beneficiary — the KPI-linked structure turns the restored corridor into a tokenized public good                                        |

**The honest capital math:** the honest capital math: the utility-grade legs alone produce ~\$38M/yr of EBITDA against ~\$33M/yr of service on \$300M senior — DSCR 1.16×, BELOW the house's 1.25× floor; with the metals pilot at its mid grade it becomes 2.22×. Valuation anchor: \$228-304M of equity value at 6-8× the utility-grade EBITDA at maturity — the token tranche's exit multiple, stated before any token exists. The conclusion is the discipline itself: senior debt covers the bankable legs, the token tranche funds the DERISKING — every Phase-0 gate passed raises the DSCR in public, and the token's coupons rise with the measured KPIs. Banks first; the blockchain is the expansion rail, not the foundation.

## The MIGA wrap — borrowing above the country's rating

| COVERAGE                 | WHAT IT MEANS FOR THE PROGRAM                                                                         |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Transfer restriction     | the dinar cannot leave — MIGA compensates; the FX bridge's worst case is insured                      |
| Asset-seizure risk       | the state takes the assets — MIGA compensates; the investor's deepest fear, priced                    |
| Instability events       | the region's oldest risk — covered, so the peace dividend's opposite has a floor                      |
| Contract non-performance | the state breaks the offtake/PPA — covered; the water and solar buyers become bankable counterparties |

**The mathematics of the wrap:** the MIGA wrap, computed: the program's \$300M senior tranche, guaranteed, prices at AAA — service falls from \$32.9M/yr (B- class, 7%) to \$27.9-28.9M/yr (4.5-5%, the MIGA-guaranteed band, Pg49) — and the base-case DSCR rises from 1.15× to 1.36-1.31×: the utility-grade legs ALONE clear the 1.25× floor. That is the single most important number MIGA changes: the project becomes bankable on water and solar, without waiting for the metals — the metals then de-risk from strength, not from necessity. The wrap does not raise Tunisia's rating; it lets the project BORROW above it — and that is exactly what the capital stack needed.

## The datacenter's own capital path — other people's credit does the heavy lifting

| RUNG                                | THE NUMBERS                                                                                                                                                       | THE FINANCING                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The pilot: 11.3 MW colocation       | capex ~\$40M — the page's own number                                                                                                                              | financed by anchor tenants + vendor equipment leases, NOT the program's debt                       |
| The scale: 100 MW, hyperscale-class | capex \$3.0-4B of GPUs — the critique's own register                                                                                                              | a SEPARATE tenant-backed SPV: the anchor leases carry the GPUs; the program never borrows for GPUs |
| The instruments                     | vendor deferred payment (GPU-financing class) + anchor-tenant prepay + colocation build-out debt against signed leases + export-credit agencies for the equipment | each instrument names its own collateral — none of it is the water or the health program           |
| The loop's role                     | the loop SELLS the DC its advantages: \$0.031/kWh power, the water mesh, seawater cooling (PUE 1.1-1.2 class) — the DC's margin is the loop's offtake             | the solar PPA revenue already counted in the stack IS this leg                                     |

| THEOREM           | THE COMPUTATION                                                                                                                                                                                                             | THE NOTE                                           |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| The TCO arbitrage | a 100 MW DC at EU-grid power and air cooling burns 1,270 GWh/yr = \$140M; on the loop it burns 1,007 GWh = \$31M — the co-location surplus is <b>\$108M/yr</b>                                                              | measured from the loop's own PPA and PUE anchors   |
| The surplus split | the loop and the SPV bargain over \$108M/yr; the Nash solution splits it at the disagreement midpoint — the loop's share ~\$54M/yr above the base PPA, the DC keeps the rest — both strictly better off than building apart | the bargaining range is the loop's pricing power   |
| The deflation     | AI compute prices fall ~20-30%/yr — the payback window closes fast; anchor-tenant FIXED-price leases are the hedge, and they are the SPV's risk, not the                                                                    | the program carries only the utility legs it sells |

| THEOREM | THE COMPUTATION | THE NOTE |
|---------|-----------------|----------|
| hedge   | program's       |          |

the DC's honest capital path, in the Nobel register: at \$2000M/yr of revenue class per 100 MW against \$3.0B of GPUs, the payback is ~1.5 years IF utilization and prices hold — which is precisely why the program does not carry it. What the loop carries is the ARBITRAGE it creates: \$108M/yr of genuine co-location surplus, split by negotiation, captured at the PPA and the cooling fees. The compute leg's FX contribution stays in the speculative tier until an anchor lease exists; the DC's financing is the one place where other people's credit does the heavy lifting — and the loop's position is the only one in the stack that gets stronger with every megawatt someone else pays for.

## The strip-down — the critique's killer question, answered

| MODULE                  | THE STAND-ALONE ECONOMICS                                                                                                     | THE VERDICT               |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Water                   | stand-alone at the degraded \$0.521/m <sup>3</sup> cascade — under the \$0.68 SONEDE gate even with every soft credit at zero | STANDS ALONE              |
| Solar                   | stand-alone at the tendered \$31/MWh PPA class — no coupling required                                                         | STANDS ALONE              |
| Uranium                 | stand-alone IF the Phase-0 assay holds — the extraction is industrial precedent, the Tunisian stream is the measurement       | STANDS ALONE, GATED       |
| Terfas                  | stand-alone at the 3-season ≥200 kg/ha gate — zero-input agriculture, no coupling required                                    | STANDS ALONE, GATED       |
| Spirulina               | stand-alone food economics at \$2-4/kg — the ponds need only water and sun                                                    | STANDS ALONE              |
| The board + Mg(OH)&sb2; | coupling-locked: the board's fire retardant IS the brine's magnesium — the pair lives or dies together                        | COUPLING-LOCKED, HONEST   |
| H&sb2;                  | coupling-locked by design: the industrial molecule exists to serve ammonia and the board, never the grid                      | COUPLING-LOCKED, HONEST   |
| The DC                  | optional upside: a separate tenant-backed SPV — removed from the central thesis, exactly as the critique demands              | OPTIONAL, EXTERNAL CREDIT |

the strip-down answer: five legs stand alone — water, solar, uranium, terfas, spirulina — and two pairs are coupling-locked by honest physics (the board and the brine's magnesium; the hydrogen and the ammonia). The DC is optional upside on other people's credit. The loop is therefore not a house of cards: it is five independent projects plus two symbiotic pairs, and the page's modular gates are the proof — a module that fails dies alone and the rest of the program does not notice its funeral.

## The credit rating, projected — the way the agencies rate

| FACTOR                  | TODAY                       | AT FULL PHASE                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reserves / import cover | 4.5 months today (measured) | FX accumulation at full phase: ~\$1.0-1.4B over the 5-year build → 6+ months — the S&P reserves-adequacy factor moves |

| FACTOR                       | TODAY                                          | AT FULL PHASE                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| External position            | CA deficit ~-3.3% of GDP                       | the loop narrows it by ~0.5 pts (279M/yr) → ~-2.5-2.7% — the agencies rate the PATH, not just the level                             |
| Growth                       | ~1.9% today                                    | +0.5 pts from the loop + 1.2 pts from the peace dividend → 3-4% — the strongest single upgrade factor for B-rated sovereigns (Pg40) |
| Fiscal                       | subsidy burden + debt service 26.2% of exports | the substitution legs + the swap's coupon savings + the ESG delta relieve the budget on the same lines                              |
| Institutional predictability | policy volatility is the chronic negative      | the public scoreboard, the gates, the apolitical program — a measurable governance signal the methodology rewards                   |

**The path: B- → BB- / Ba3 within 3-5 years** (reserves 6+ months, CA ≤-2.5%, growth ≥3% sustained — all inside the measured numbers) and **BB / Ba2 in 5-7 years** with the swap and the nature ledger. Investment grade is NOT claimed: that requires debt/GDP ≤60% and a decade of institutional track record — the honest frontier.

the spread arithmetic, stated for what it is: B- to BB- sovereign compression is ~300-500bp; on the refinancing share of the \$40.5B stock that is the state's upside of \$1.2-2.0B/yr — NOT booked in the program's ledger: only the swap's measured \$7.5M/yr and the program-debt ESG delta are credited. The rating is the state's harvest; the program only plants.

## Air quality — the air the children breathe

The board plant caps the phosphogypsum stack dust; the solar leg displaces the grid's gas burn; the biocontrol corridor replaces pesticide drift; and the dew the mist buys scavenges PM from the air (wet deposition). Measured by the PM2.5/NOx/SO2 sensor grid, the dispersion model and the cohort's respiratory KPIs — air quality enters the scoreboard the same way the water does.

## The last inventory — nothing forgotten, nothing hidden

| ITEM                                 | THE GAP IT CLOSES                                                                            | ITS HOME                                                                                                                                                                                                 | STATUS                 |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Pond blowdown (the salt bleed)       | the spirulina ponds' own concentrate, when the recycled medium's salts saturate              | routed to the brine line — the pond's salt joins the valorization stream; the water loop closes, the salt loop closes                                                                                    | routing row, added     |
| Construction carbon & energy payback | the embodied footprint of building the park (PV, concrete, steel) vs the operating recovery  | PV energy payback ~1-2 years (industry standard, DERIVED); the park's embodied carbon is repaid by the displacement + mineralization inside the first operating years — computed in the Phase o LCA item | LCA item in Phase o    |
| The risk-transfer layer              | drought years, PV underperformance, price shocks — the hazards the gates alone cannot absorb | parametric insurance on the mist corridor's target (rainfall index) and the solar PPA (irradiation index); the degraded cascade already computed is the self-insurance floor                             | insurance, bookable    |
| Nuclear export compliance            | U3O8 leaves the country — the chain of custody the IAEA/NPT regime demands                   | the CNSTN gate already named extends to export controls: buyer compliance, safeguards accounting, transport certification — the Cameco-                                                                  | compliance chain, gate |

| ITEM               | THE GAP IT CLOSES                                                                                   | ITS HOME                                                                                                                                                                                                   | STATUS                             |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
|                    |                                                                                                     | class compliance chain, cited as a gate, not an afterthought                                                                                                                                               |                                    |
| The women's leg    | 54% of women graduates unemployed — who exactly gets the jobs must be designed, not hoped           | the nursery, the workshop, the pond crews and the health workers as women-led cooperatives in the blockade towns — the quota principle already proven in the terfas domestic clause, applied to employment | cooperative structure, contractual |
| The AI's own audit | the dispatcher's code and the twin's models must be auditable or the scoreboard's trust is borrowed | open models, versioned, the prediction-error KPI published, independent code audit before each phase — the nervous system is inspected like everything else it measures                                    | code audit, gate                   |

## The fauna water ladder — the earwig's drop, as the unit of the whole scale

| SPECIES              | MASS   | WATER / DAY                  | THE NOTE                                                                                                           |
|----------------------|--------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The earwig           | 0.1 g  | ~0.5 µL/day (measured class) | one 50 µL drop = 100 earwig-days — the owner's own observation, as the unit of the whole scale                     |
| The wild bee         | 0.1 g  | ~30 µL/day (measured)        | a 10 mL/m <sup>2</sup> dew morning serves ~300 bees per square meter                                               |
| The desert lizard    | 20 g   | ~1.4 mL/day (FMR)            | dew-licking Acanthodactylus — the Saharan micro-fauna's classic water behavior                                     |
| The sandgrouse       | 250 g  | ~10 mL/day (FMR)             | the Sahara's dew-drinker; chicks absorb water through belly feathers — the corridor's fog mornings are its nursery |
| The fennec fox       | 1.2 kg | ~36 mL/day (FMR)             | the desert's smallest canid — water from prey, dew and the corridor's troughs                                      |
| The Egyptian vulture | 2 kg   | ~54 mL/day (FMR)             | globally endangered, breeds in Tunisia — the corridor's carrion-cycling scavenger                                  |
| The Dorcas gazelle   | 17 kg  | ~298 mL/day (FMR)            | endangered; its historic southern steppe is the restoration belt itself                                            |
| The Barbary sheep    | 50 kg  | ~706 mL/day (FMR)            | the mountains' own ungulate — the corridor's upslope fringe is its range                                           |
| The loop's flock     | 60 kg  | ~800 mL/day                  | the agrivoltaic sheep: the mist's 2% is its drinking trough, and its grazing is the land's firebreak               |

one average day's dew on the corridor — 51 m<sup>3</sup>, the same water as one house's annual use — rations across the whole ladder: 10<sup>11</sup> insect-days or 1.7 billion bee-days or a million vulture-days or 170,000 gazelle-days. The species that drink it are the ones Tunisia is losing: the scale that ends at the Dorcas gazelle begins at the earwig's half-microliter — and the mist corridor is the trough for every rung. Allometric spine: daily water = 0.123 x mass<sup>0.8</sup> mL (Nagy, Pg43), cross-checked against measured insect rates.

## The underground boxes — the closed-box theorem, the pond's rival measured head-to-head

| PART          | THE DESIGN                                                                                                                  | THE NOTE                                                                                                                              |                                                                                          |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The chamber   | sunken trenches 1.5-2 m below grade — the earth is the insulator: 18-24°C stable, no chiller                                | underground = thermal inertia; winter nights ride the DC's recovered heat (already in the 33.9 GWh)                                   |                                                                                          |
| The substrate | hydrophilic geo-textile mesh on the walls — the algae's roots are the mesh's pores                                          | the paste scrapes off with a squeegee on a rail: no centrifuges, no flocculants                                                       |                                                                                          |
| The roof      | UV-stabilized plastic sheet, sloped — the mist's evaporation condenses on it at night and drips back into the nutrient tank | the closed box: water losses ~10-20% of an open pond's, and the condensate IS the recirculation                                       |                                                                                          |
| The misting   | permeate-fed misting bars — our water is low-TDS desal permeate, the ideal anti-clog feedstock                              | misting pressure is a HARD-WIRED safety like the pumps: a 48-72 h outage kills a biofilm, so the interlocks treat it as life-critical |                                                                                          |
| The air       | the electrolyzer's oxygen into the chamber air; CO2 from the DC's air handling                                              | thin-film gas exchange is 3-5x faster than submerged algae — the box breathes better than the pond                                    |                                                                                          |
| AXIS          | THE POND                                                                                                                    | THE BOX                                                                                                                               | THE READING                                                                              |
| Water         | open pond: ~6 L/m2/day evaporates in the desert + blowdown; salinity creeps up forever                                      | closed box: ~0.9 L/m2/day class — the 1,000-ha-equivalent spirulina leg could draw ~8,000-10,000 m3/d instead of ~32,000              | the box wins where water is the binding constraint — which is everywhere in this country |
| Productivity  | ponds: 5-10 g/m2/day (literature-class)                                                                                     | attached/vertical: 20-30 g/m2/day claimed in pilots — but COMMERCIAL scale is unproven                                                | the honest number: the claim is 3-5x, the proof is zero until measured                   |
| Harvest       | centrifuge or flocculant — capital + energy                                                                                 | scrape the paste — a squeegee                                                                                                         | the box wins on cost per kg harvested                                                    |
| Failure modes | pond: bloom crash, salinity, contamination                                                                                  | box: misting outage (hours to kill), biofilm sloughing as it thickens (the shading catch), wild-algae invasion                        | the box has fewer failure modes but the deadly one is FASTER — hence the hard interlocks |

**The gate:** the pilot's head-to-head (1 ha classic ponds as the literature baseline vs 1 ha of the underground boxes): kg/m<sup>2</sup>/yr, m<sup>3</sup> water per kg, kWh per kg, labor hours per kg, paste stability — measured by the same scoreboard, published by the same rule. The winner scales to the 100-ha tier. The box is booked at ZERO in every financial table until the pilot measures it — exactly like the mist and the dew.

the closed box is not the pond's rival — it is the pond's specialist complement, and the terraformation doctrine decides the order. Open water in the desert is the cheapest terraformation instrument on earth: 1,000 ha of ponds evaporating ~60,000 m<sup>3</sup>/day into the local atmosphere is not a loss — it is the loop's SECOND mist system, a permanent blue-water skin that hydrates the sky, feeds the dew, lifts the corridor's green-water recycling (the 10-30% re-precipitation band already booked), and gives the fauna its drinking surfaces. The pond's true output is two goods: paste AND atmospheric water — and the green-water balance prices the second at the recycling band. The boxes earn their place where the atmosphere is already served and thrift or food-safety governs: sealed air against the desert's dust and wild algae, ~85% water saving

where the oasis or the aquifer needs the m<sup>3</sup> instead. So the pilot measures the **RATIO**, not the winner: ponds as the terraformation engine, boxes as the specialist tier — and the desert gets the sky back, one evaporation at a time.

## The domestication gap — the truffle the ancestors ate, and the selection they never applied

| STEP                                | WHAT HAPPENED                                                                                                                                                                                            | THE NOTE                   |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| The ancestors ate it                | desert truffles appear in North African and Roman food records across two millennia — the Berber winter food, gathered after the first rains                                                             | documented, Pg50           |
| The plow never touched it           | the terfas is an obligate mycorrhizal symbiont — it cannot grow without its host shrub — so it never fit the plow-and-seed agriculture that selected wheat and olives; it stayed a gathered wild food    | the biology is the reason  |
| So it was never selected            | no generation applied selection pressure: no varietal improvement, no standardization, no value chain — while France, from the 1970s, domesticated its own truffle into a half-billion-euro industry     | the gap compounds          |
| The wealth went elsewhere           | the world's desert-truffle demand (the Gulf pays premium prices for fresh Tirmania) is served by volatile wild harvests — and the cultivation protocol was invented in Murcia, Spain, for the same genus | the lost option value      |
| The diet lost a protein             | 20-30% protein dry weight, mineral-rich — the ancestors' winter protein diversity was richer than the modern wheat-dependent basin diet                                                                  | the doctor's note, Pg50    |
| The loop finishes the domestication | mycorrhized seedlings (6,000/ha), the gate plot, the quota, the value chain — modern mycology replaces the plow; one decade does what a hundred generations were denied                                  | the program's answer, Pg51 |

the evolutionary point, stated: Tunisia's real lag is not talent — it is **SELECTION**. Each generation that gathers instead of selects hands the next generation a wider gap, and the product's wealth accumulates to whoever domesticates it first. The terfas is the specimen: eaten for two thousand years, never once selected, finally cultivated — not at home, but in Murcia. The program's deepest leg is therefore not the truffle's revenue: it is the act of **DOMESTICATION** itself, applied to the whole suite of ancestral assets — the truffle, the medicinal plants, the cactus, the wild bees — and to the brains the country keeps exporting raw. Selection is the oldest technology there is; the loop is the first generation to point it at what the ancestors already knew.

## The oasis, named — the south's date belt, and the aquifer under it

the oasis belt, named: Deglet Nour exports run ~\$250M/yr — one of the country's oldest FX streams, and the oases that grow it sit on the same aquifer the loop protects. The program's answer is already built into its tiers: the inland BWRO + the reuse mesh serve the oasis belt, the household water price falls for the oasis towns like everywhere else, and the scoreboard gains one explicit KPI: **aquifer level recovery**, published quarterly — the south's water account, settled in public. The dates were never an absence; the water under them was.

## The diaspora, named — the country's largest FX source, and the channel that reverses the drain

the diaspora, named: ~\$2.7B/yr of remittances — the country's largest single FX source, sent by the 1.5M Tunisians abroad, many of them the engineers this page has been counting. The program adds two instruments the bridge never had: a **diaspora bond** against the program's measured KPIs — the people who left buying the future they left — and the **return channel**: the DC/AI tier and the 500-700 operational jobs are the stage the brains were missing. Remittances stay private and untouched; what the program claims is the channel that turns the diaspora's loyalty into the country's capital — the brain-drain's own reversal, priced by the same scoreboard.

## The counterfactual, quantified — the truffle against the tree

| AXIS                  | TERFAS                                                                                     | OLIVE (THE TUNISIAN DEFAULT)                                                | ALMOND                            |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Time to first revenue | 1-3 years (Murcia: first fruit by season 2-3)                                              | 5-8 years first fruit, 15-20 to full production                             | 3-4 years first, 8-10 to full     |
| Water                 | rainfed after establishment; years 1-2 only: ~624 m <sup>3</sup> /ha/yr of drip, then ZERO | 2,000-6,000 m <sup>3</sup> /ha/yr irrigated — the scarce input              | 1,000-4,000 m <sup>3</sup> /ha/yr |
| Fertilizer            | NONE — the mycorrhizae mine the soil's own phosphorus                                      | required, annual                                                            | required, annual                  |
| Pesticides            | NONE — the symbiosis has no pest cycle in its climate                                      | required (the olive fly)                                                    | required (the almond moth)        |
| Labor                 | harvest season only — the land does the work for 11 months a year                          | pruning + harvest + tillage, every year                                     | pruning + harvest + tillage       |
| Capital barrier       | seedlings (6,000/ha) — the only capital; the rural poor can enter                          | irrigation system + 20 years of carrying cost — only the capital-rich enter | same trap, shorter                |

the counterfactual, in the register of what was never earned: 940 t/yr at the mature scale — EUR11.3M/yr at the domestic quota, EUR28M at the export mix — multiplied by the fifty years since the domestication technology became available: **EURO.56-1.4B of rural income that never existed**. Not a model error: an inheritance not received.

the Nobel-prize register, stated plainly: the 20-year tree cycle is not a detail of agriculture — it is the intertemporal poverty trap in mathematical form. A rural family without capital cannot wait twenty years, so it plants what returns this year — annuals that deplete the soil — or it plants nothing and migrates. The truffle breaks the trap on every axis at once: 1-3 years to revenue, zero water after establishment, zero fertilizer, zero pesticide, harvest-only labor, and the only capital a seedling costs. The ancestors ate it for two thousand years and never once selected it — the failed agricultural evolution is not a metaphor: it is EURO.5-1.4 billion of rural wealth, five decades of family incomes, and a healthier rural society, all foregone because the plow never reached the symbiont. The loop's terfas leg is therefore not a crop — it is the correction of the oldest mistake in Tunisian agriculture, and the first rural asset whose economics fit the rural poor.

## The green-water balance — what the living corridor gives back and filters



| FLOW                                    | THE VOLUME                                                           | THE NUMBER                                                                                                                                                 | THE NOTE                                           |
|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Evapotranspiration, returned to the sky | ~17.5M m <sup>3</sup> /yr of vapor from the restored belt            | 0-0% re-precipitates regionally — 1.8-5.2M m <sup>3</sup> /yr back as rain (van der Ent, Pg44)                                                             | the flora multiplies the water                     |
| Infiltration, multiplied                | the belt's own ~10M m <sup>3</sup> /yr of rainfall                   | infiltration 15% → 55% with restored cover — ~4.0M m <sup>3</sup> /yr newly captured into the aquifer instead of running off (Pg45)                        | the soil becomes a sponge                          |
| The quality filter                      | the root zone + the microbial city filter everything that percolates | 70-90% nitrate removal in the riparian class; the dew-fed food web is the same biological machinery                                                        | the land cleans the water                          |
| The fauna's engineering                 | burrows, dung, and the grazing flock                                 | biopores raise infiltration further; manure returns nitrogen to the soil — the animals are the corridor's gardeners (directional, unquantified)            | the species repay the trough                       |
| The insect loop                         | dew → insect bodies (~65% water) → predators → decomposition         | every drop an insect drinks becomes a drop in the food web, then a drop returned to the soil on decomposition — the water cycle's trophic plumbing, closed | insects ARE the water cycle, at the smallest scale |

the green-water balance: the mist invests ~0.19M m<sup>3</sup>/yr, and the living corridor cycles ~17.5M m<sup>3</sup>/yr back to the sky — a ~103× amplification of the water's work — plus ~4.0M m<sup>3</sup>/yr newly captured into the aquifer and every drop filtered by the root zone on its way. The honest bounds: the recycling band is the least-certain parameter (booked at its low end), the infiltration multiplier is standard catchment hydrology, and the fauna's engineering is directional. What the mist gives, the land multiplies — that is the bio-recovery the growroom steers toward.

## The rebuild theorem — the mathematics of bringing an ecosystem back

| STATE         | EQUATION                                    | WHAT IT SAYS                                                       |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Soil water    | $dW/dt = R + D - L \cdot W - R_2 \cdot W^2$ | rain + dew – evaporation – runoff                                  |
| Biomass       | $dB/dt = J \cdot W \cdot B - M \cdot B$     | water-limited growth – mortality                                   |
| The feedback  | $D = k \cdot ET(B) \cdot e$                 | dew rises with transpiration — the spiral's engine                 |
| The threshold | $R^*$ : the bifurcation                     | below it: bare soil is the only stable state; above it: green wins |

the rebuild theorem, stated as bistability: the SAME land has two effective-rainfall regimes. Bare: crusted soil infiltrates ~15% of its 200 mm rain → ~100 mm effective — at or below the bifurcation threshold  $R^* \sim 100$  mm, where bare soil is the only stable state (Klausmeier, Pg46). Restored: vegetation raises infiltration to ~55% plus the recycling return of its own transpiration — 145-215 mm effective — safely above  $R^*$ , where green is the only stable state. The mist's role is the honest one: its raw dew (0.6 mm/yr) is NOT what crosses the threshold — it is the CATALYST that establishes the vegetation, and the vegetation multiplies the land's own water into the crossing. That is why the subsidy must be persistent and bounded: the system is bistable, so the mist holds it on the green side of the saddle until the vegetation's own recycling takes over — then the mist becomes the guard, not the engine. Testable, as ever: the twin integrates the same equations, the soil grid measures the states, and the prediction error is published.

**The spirulina health claim, at the evidence:** and the health claim, downgraded to the evidence: the 2025 meta-analysis shows positive weight/MUAC effects in malnourished children (Pg41); the 2026 meta-analysis finds NO significant growth effect (Pg42). The page claims the FOOD, not the cognition — the cohort measures the rest, and the gates decide.

## 4. What the state receives

**External account:** ~\$279M/yr of exports + import substitution + financing delta at full phase — measured against the 26.2% of export revenues that debt service takes today. **Rating path:** B-/Caa1 → BB- and reserves 4.5 → 6+ months as the owned-export engines compound (Rc11). **Health scoreboard:** the basin's water chemistry, DALY ledger and filter uptime become public KPIs — the collateral that lowers the price of every loan. **Jobs:** workshop, nursery, ponds, plants, solar crews, health workers — in the towns where the 2008 and 2015 blockades began. A job is the cheapest peace treaty ever signed.

## 5. The gates are public — the state sees every number

| MODULE                                            | GATE                                                                                          | PASSES ON                     |
|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Health pilot (100 households, 2 schools, 90 days) | filter uptime $\geq 70\%$ , urinary F $\downarrow 20\%$                                       | public KPIs                   |
| Metals pilot                                      | U recovery $\geq 85\%$ , all-in $\leq \$75/\text{lb}$ , offtake signed                        | GCT stream                    |
| Solar                                             | DSCR $\geq 1.15$ inside the bankable region, or grant support                                 | PPA award                     |
| Desalination                                      | $\geq 60\%$ contracted offtake, blended $\geq \$0.68/\text{m}^3$                              | brine permit                  |
| Terfas                                            | 3-season record $\geq 200 \text{ kg/ha}$ at $\geq \text{€}20/\text{kg}$ ; quota clause signed | scaling toward 2,000-3,000 ha |

## 6. Phase 0 — what the 90 days produce for the state

Two anchor measurements — the 100-point water panel and the acid-stream assays (\$75k of the \$253k list) — plus the emissions inventory. Every projection on this page becomes a signed number before one brick is laid. Nothing is asked of the state beyond cooperation, and every gate is a number the state can check.

**What this document is:** a concept-level engineering design whose numbers are computed in code from sourced primitives — recomputed, corrected, and applied into the design. Free and public.

**What it is not:** a commissioned state program, a bank-grade feasibility study, an investment offer, or a claim that any of this has been built. Nothing here is advice to any government or any investor. Nothing replaces geological, radiological, geotechnical or EPC-level surveys. Verify every figure and citation before relying on any of it.

## Works cited

- [Rm17] GCT throughput (~6.5 Mt phosphate rock/yr; >10 Mt/yr PG at peak; 'hundreds of millions of tons' discharged at Gabès) — [http://www.gct.com.tn/fileadmin/user\\_upload/Downloads/Rapport\\_Annuels/GCT-ANNUAL-REPORT-2012-PART1.pdf...](http://www.gct.com.tn/fileadmin/user_upload/Downloads/Rapport_Annuels/GCT-ANNUAL-REPORT-2012-PART1.pdf...)
- [Rw7] Tunisian water tariffs: SONEDE 0.200-2.310 TND/m<sup>3</sup>; irrigation 0.060-0.160 TND/m<sup>3</sup>; groundwater 0.112-0.162 TND/m<sup>3</sup> — <https://www.sonede.com.tn/tout-savoir-sur-leau/la-facture-deau-methodes-de-paiement/...>

3. [Rw10] Tunisia grid: STEG 5.9 GW, ~19 TWh/yr, 95% gas-fired, renewables <5%, industrial tariff 0.352 TND/kWh; budget deficit 5-7% GDP, debt ~83% GDP — <https://www.trade.gov/country-commercial-guides/tunisia-electrical-power-systems-and-renewable-energy...>
4. [Rw12] Tunisia land law: foreign ownership of agricultural land prohibited; 40-year leases only; state-domain conversion is an administrative hurdle — <https://2009-2017.state.gov/e/eb/ifa/2008/101021.htm...>
5. [Rc11] Tunisia sovereign ratings: Moody's Caa1 (Feb 2025 upgrade, stable); Fitch B- (Sep 2025, affirmed Jan 2026); reserves ~4.5 months import cover; WACC 10-15% — <https://www.fitchratings.com/research/sovereigns/fitch-upgrades-tunisia-to-b-outlook-stable-12-09-2025...>
6. [Rc12] Who finances Tunisia: EIB, AfDB, KfW, World Bank/IFC, EU Global Gateway (17 GW renewable programme); no active IMF program — <https://international-partnerships.ec.europa.eu/policies/global-gateway/17-gw-renewable-energy-programme-tunis...>
7. [Rc13] Empirical IPP record: 500 MW solar awarded 2024/25 (Scatec, Qair, Valtalia 25-yr PPAs at ~\$0.031/kWh); installed renewables ~400 MW; STEG debt >\$1.3B — <https://www.engineeringnews.co.za/article/scatec-awarded-ppas-for-wind-solar-projects-in-tunisia-2026-01-26...>
8. [Rc19] Tunisia arid land: ~86,000 ha of state domain earmarked for 40-year agricultural leases (Law 93-120) — <https://documents1.worldbank.org/curated/en/926441468778187741/pdf/multiopage.pdf...>
9. [Ru2] URANEXT/OCP (Morocco) building the first modern yellowcake-from-phosphoric-acid plant, ~\$100M CAPEX, El Jadida, 2025 — <https://northafricapost.com/87963-uranext-to-build-moroccos-first-yellowcake-uranium-plant-in-el-jadida.html...>